
I am
The Snail Hunter


Floreana, Galápagos Islands

Floreana has been transformed





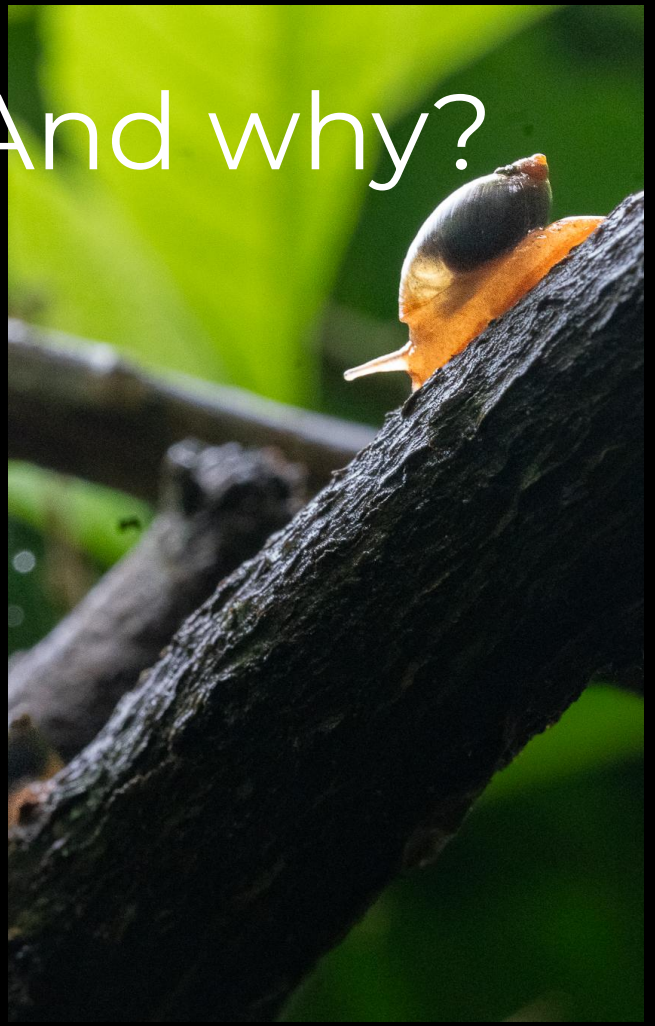


Slow moving but ecologically fast

What is still there? And why?









Who survives?

Where?
With whom?
Why?



Survival is the first chapter of the story

WHAT vs. WHY

Describing research	Communicating research
What do I study?	What is the problem?
What did I do?	What don't we know yet?
What methods did I use?	How will this approach resolve the gap?
What did I find?	Why should you want the answer?

From: “Here is my research”
To: “Here is the problem that made my research necessary”

THIS AFTERNOON: FROM STORIES TO GRANTS

1. **Why should anyone care?**
   - Finding the core story in your research
   - Talks · papers · grants · job applications
2. **Grant writing**
   - Turning a scientific story into a persuasive argument to get $$$
3. **NIH + Specific Aims**
   - One structured example of how to do it
   - **Homework:** prepare a Specific Aims page

BREAKOUT: GIVE US A REASON TO CARE

Work in pairs — 8-10 minutes

Think (2 min, on your own): Explain your research *without starting with your methods or organism of study.* Think:

- What is the problem?
- What don't we know?
- Why does it matter?
- What are you trying to find out?

Pair (4 min): Present to each other, 2 min each.

- **Listener**: At what point did you start to care?

Share (2 min): Help each other sharpen your scientific story. Take notes of what works and what doesn't..

YOUR SCIENTIFIC STORY TRAVELS WITH YOU

TALKS

What should this audience understand and remember?

PAPERS

What is the problem, gap, and contribution?

GRANTS

Why is this worth investing in?

JOB APPLICATIONS

Why does your work matter, and what is your direction?

YOUR SCIENTIFIC STORY TRAVELS WITH YOU

The same scientific story appears everywhere.

The format changes → the core story does not.

GRANT WRITING
communication + persuasion

Why does this problem matter?

Why is your approach worth trying?

Why should someone invest in it?

A strong grant does not just *describe* good science.

It makes the case for *WHY* it is worth doing.